



Missing marsupial

The last Tasmanian tiger is thought to have died in a zoo in 1936. It was striped like a tiger and had a thick tail like a kangaroo. Farmers shot them all because they ate sheep.



Acting star

Opossums are the only living American marsupials. When a Virginia opossum is attacked, it sticks out its tongue, lies very still, and pretends to be dead—it plays possum!



Honey possum



Numbat



Ring-tailed rock wallaby

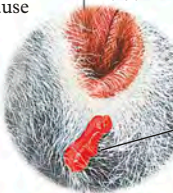


Tasmanian devil



Jumping bean?

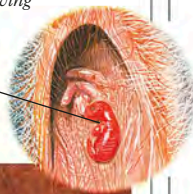
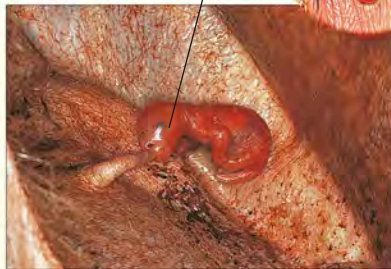
A newborn wallaby looks like a red bean! It is less than one inch (two cm) long and has no legs, hair, or eyes. Like all marsupials, it continues to grow in a pouch, not inside the mother's body.



The "bean" squirms through the forest of hair by waving its stumpy arms.

Three minutes later it reaches the pouch.

It hooks onto a nipple and starts to suck milk.



Hold on tight

This baby koala is too big to fit inside its mother's pouch, so it clings to her fur as she climbs through the eucalyptus leaves!

Mammals with pouches